Good Presentations: Preparation and Delivery

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Objectives

What do you want to achieve?

- Educate and Inform
- Hold and Grab the attention of the audience

Elements of a good presentation

- Planning your presentation
- Structure of your presentation
- Prepare slides
- Delivery

Planning

Purpose and Audience

Why? Where? Duration?

Conference talk, research seminar, thesis defense, interviews, job talk, etc.

Planning and Structure

What story you want to tell?

How you want to tell the story?

- It's not a written story; it's a performance
- Time is never enough
- Meticulously design and organize your story
- Make your audience listen and understand

Structure of your presentation

Convincing and strong beginning

- Tell what you want to tell – crisply
- Create an impression – you are well prepared and confident

Tell the story

- Make a story board – iteratively improve
- Break up sections and present incrementally

Closing – reinforce the take-home message

- Clear, simple and brief end
- Reinforce the “big picture”

Prepare your slides

Neat and Not Overloaded

Avoid writing paragraphs

Use (moderate) colors to emphasize

Use (appropriately) large and nice fonts

Use Visual aids and (moderate) Animations

Delivery

- Dress well; do not be nervous (show your confidence)
- Do not read your slides
- Synchronization between slides and speech
- Repetition is not always bad
- Appropriate variations in tone – avoid monotone
- Appropriate eye contact
- Do not cover your slides

Delivery

- Practice – remember it's a performance
- Do not overpractice – don't be a robot
- Deliver with energy and enthusiasm
- Do not "overdo" anything – simple and moderate
- Manage your time – not too fast; skip if necessary
- Prepare to deal with mistakes – smile works :)

Audience Etiquette

Be Respectful and Considerate

Acknowledgement

- Md. Saidur Rahman, How to give a good presentation in computer science, Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology.

- Roberto Cipolla, How to prepare and deliver a presentation, University of Cambridge, https://mi.eng.cam.ac.uk/~cipolla/archive/Presentations/MakingPresentations.pdf (accessed Nov 2024)

- Stephen Clark, How to give a technical presentation in computer science, University of Ulster, https://dps.uibk.ac.at/~tf/lehre/ResearchPresentation. (accessed Nov 2024)

- Bahar Martonosi (Princeton University), How to give a good presentation, CompArch Summer School on Parallel Programming and Architectures, Brown University, 2008, https://www.princeton.edu/~archss/webpdfs08/BaharMartonosi.pdf (accessed Nov 2024)

Thank You

Questions

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Planning and Structure

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Stress at BUET and beyond

Why do we need to talk about
Stress Management?

BUET is an exciting time full of new opportunities,
but with these opportunities comes some
stressful times as well

Stress at BUET and beyond

Why am I talking about
Stress Management?

Stress at BUET and beyond

Why am I talking about
Stress Management?

I share a common academic/career path with you

Stress at BUET and beyond

- Academic
- Dorm/Hall life

Stress at BUET and beyond

- Academic
- Dorm/Hall life
- Higher studies abroad

Delivery

Dress well; do not be nervous (show your confidence)

Synchronization between slides and speech

Use (appropriate) colors to emphasize

Use (appropriately) large and nice fonts

Use Visual aids and Animations

Stresses at BUET dorm life

- Privacy issues and shared facilities
  - Many of you are not used to share your room
- Living standard
  - Food, washroom and other facilities will likely be worse than your home

Stresses at BUET dorm life

- Privacy issues and shared facilities
  - Many of you are not used to share your room
- Living standard
  - Food, washroom and other facilities will likely be worse than your home
- Ragging/bullying
  - Really unfortunate!

Stress at BUET and beyond

Do they sound too
Stressful?

Stress at BUET and beyond

Do they sound too
Stressful?

Seemingly tiny little things can get accumulated –
creating significant stress

Stress at BUET and beyond

Stress is natural

Stress at BUET and beyond

Stress is natural

(as long as it is acknowledged or managed)

Adaptability

How to deal with academic stress?

- Be serious right from the beginning
  - Start afresh
- Have good connections
  - A good friend circle, good relationships with seniors, juniors and with teachers
- Understand your limitations and set your priorities
  - Extra effort
  - Redefine your goals

How to deal with academic stuff?

» Time management and discipline

- Stop procrastination.
- Make small steps to solve large problems.

» Never give up

- Keep trying – you have 8 semesters to come back.

How to deal with dorm/hall life?

- Take some time
  - Get it some time and it will just solve itself
- Walk away from conflict
  - Once it gets intense, there's no way back
- Receiving/Accepting mentality
  - Flexible and open mindset

Managing stresses

What if **you are**
(or **going to be**)
Stressed?

Stay Calm

Staying Calm

- **Slow down your racing mind – go slow, buy some time**
  Otherwise, you feel trapped, which makes you even more anxious and stressed, and the cycle continues
- **Have a personal Sanctuary – turn to you and relax**
- **Start positive thinking – Yes I can do it**
- **Understand your limits – reassess your goals**
- **Practice saying NO – do not get overwhelmed with all YES**

Staying Calm

- Understand the power of "ignorance" – not knowing everything is sometimes a bliss
- Don't suffer alone – Surround yourself with people you trust to feel safe and calm
- Discipline and Time management – regain confidence and calm your mind
- Physical activities – exercises, outdoor games
- Have good sleep – calm down your brain

Never be afraid/shy to seek help

Seek help from professionals

Even before you feel like the stress has become too much to handle, reach out for help



Thank You

Questions

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